COMP3000 Computing Project

40 CREDIT MODULE

ASSESSMENT: 80% Coursework
20% Practice

MODULE LEADER: Dr Vassilis Cutsuridis (vassilis.cutsuridis@pymouth.ac.uk)

SUPERVISORS: **Dr Amir Aly, Prof Nathan Clarke, Prof Bogdan Ghita, Dr Hai-Van Dang, Dr Vasilios Kelefouras, Dr Ji-Jian Chin, Dr Lauren Ansell, Dr Rory Hopcraft, Dr Haoyi Wang, Dr Vivek Singh, Dr Muhammad Asad, Dr Shaymaa Al Jubouri, Dr Fatma Bouabdallah, Dr Nancy Girdhar, Dr Vassilis Cutsuridis**

MODULE AIMS

- To enable the student to undertake an individual project on an approved topic of interest, which addresses a significant computing-related problem relevant to the programme of study.
- To provide an opportunity for the student to integrate many of the threads of their programme of study

ASSESSED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ALO):

1. Demonstrate an investigative component to the project showing consolidation and development of knowledge and understanding relevant to their programme of study.
2. Analyse a significant computing related problem, including an examination of relevant existing approaches, and produce an approved deliverable appropriate to the programme of study that addresses the problem.
3. Manage the project effectively by demonstrating the application of project management skills.
4. Identify and take due consideration of the legal, ethical, social and professional issues that are appropriate to the project.
5. Communicate effectively all aspects of the project deliverables including the theoretical and methodological framework.
6. Evaluate the success of the project in terms of the deliverable and their approach.

Overview

This document provides information regarding the assessment requirements for the *COMP3000 Computing Project* module.

For this module you are expected to apply the complete software development lifecycle to a given problem. Students should choose to apply themselves to the topic area related to their degree. They may write a game, focus on a security problem, or consider an application of artificial intelligence. Security students must focus on Security-related topics. Research projects can be considered but they must contain some element of empirical software engineering alongside a research output, such as a paper. In short, you must write some quality code and evaluate it with rigor.

Your project title **must** reflect your degree.

The module is **assessed via two elements**: an 80% coursework (CW) and a 20% practice work (PW). You must achieve an overall module grade of 40% to pass the module. The marking rubrics towards the end of this document detail how the marks are allocated.

This is an **individual** piece of work.

The sections that follow will detail the assessment tasks that are to be undertaken. The submission and expected feedback dates are presented in Table 1. All assessments are to be submitted electronically via the module PebblePad ePortfolio before the stated deadlines.

	Submission Deadline	Feedback
00 Project Preparation	**During the first 2 weeks of the semester**	
01 Supervisor Selection	**October 10th 2025 (15:00)**	**By– final notification of supervisor**
02 Project Initiation	**October 24th 2025 (15:00)**	**During scheduled stand-ups**
03 Poster & Description for feedback	**March 16th 2026 (15:00)**	**During scheduled stand-ups**
03 Print Deadline for Poster	**April 20th 2026 (15:00)**	
04 Project ePortfolio Complete	**May 5th 2026 (15:00)**	**Within 20 working days**
Showcase	**May 7th 2026 (09:00-16:00)**	**At posters**
05 Viva	**w/c 11th May 2026**	**At the end of the Viva**

Table 1: Assessment Deadlines

This project requires the delivery of a portfolio of work. The portfolio comprises a set of 5 phases with different deliverables (see above Table), including: links to your version-controlled repository containing your code, a Video Demo of the project in action and reflections from various CPD activities. More details for these deliverables are detailed in the remainder of this document and the PebblePad ePortfolio. Once completed and submitted by the deadline given above the portfolio will be scrutinised in a Viva.

Students are requested to produce their products under a creative commons license, however if you are working with a client or wish commercial sensitivity for your project then you are free to choose an alternative. Ensure you discuss this with your supervisor.

All assessments will be introduced in the initial seminar to provide further clarity over what is expected and how you can access support and formative feedback prior to submission.

Moderation

This assignment brief has been moderated in line with the university policy.

Moderator Name	**Moderation Date**
Dr Vassilis Cutsuridis	18th September 2025

Acceptable level of generative AI tool use in this assessment element

The acceptable level of GenAI use for this coursework is detailed with the allowed uses listed below. This is split into three categories (**Solo Work** – work must be your own with no AI support, **Assisted Work** – some uses of AI tools allowed, **Partnered Work** – AI tools integral part of the work). If you have any questions, please contact the module leader.

Solo Work	You must not use generative AI tools.	☐
Assisted Work	You are permitted to use generative AI tools in an assistive role.	☒
Partnered Work	Generative AI tool use is required as an integral part of the assessment, but transparency is required.	☐

Table 2: Acceptable Level of generative AI use

Inline with the indicated acceptable level of AI use above, the following uses are acceptable:

- **A2 - Planning & Structuring Projects**
- **A3 – Code Architecture**
- **A5 - Language Refinement**
- **A6 – Code Review**
- **A7 - Code Generation for Learning Purposes**
- **A8 - Technical Guidance & Debugging Support**
- **A9 - Testing and Validation Support**

Any use of AI in your work must be declared within your documentation. You **must also include a signed Generative AI Declaration as an appendix to your submission**. The declaration form can be found on the module DLE. This form will not be included in any word count associated with this assignment.

Useful Assignment Information

Please see below some useful information regarding submissions for your modules.

Good Coding Practices

Like all things, no code is perfect. Just because your code compiles and runs does not mean it is perfect, there is always room for improvement. No code will achieve 100% of the available marks. Where code submission is required by a module, it will be assessed against the following criteria:

1) **Functionality**
   a. Does your code meet all the specified requirements of the assignment?
   b. Does your code behave correctly across typical and edge-case scenarios?
   c. Does you code have appropriate error handling that does not leading to it crashing or undefined behaviour?
2) **Efficiency**
   a. Is your code optimised in terms of performance and resource use?
   b. Does you code handle functions, variables, data calls efficiently?
   c. Is there any unnecessary repetition, complexity or processing reducing efficiency within your code?
3) **Readability**
   a. Is your code logically structured and easy to read?
   b. Have you maintained standard formatting conventions like indentations, spacing and naming, within your code?
   c. Are variables, functions, and classes clearly named and purposeful?
4) **Documentation**
   a. Are there helpful comments explaining non-obvious parts of your code?
   b. Do your comments document your process, development or rationale clearly?
   c. Could someone unfamiliar with the code understand the approach you have taken?

Use of Generative AI for Creating Code

Each assignment element for each module will have a clear indication of the permitted level of use of AI (solo, assisted or partnered) including the generation of code. Please ensure that you **read and understand the permitted use**. If you are unsure of a particular use, please reach out to the Module Leader and ask.

We strongly encourage you to read and explore beyond the core content delivered within the modules. However, this must be done correctly following academic process. Wherever code is drawn from an outside source (e.g. you have not written it yourself), regardless of whether this is AI generated or from an online repository (GitHub, Stack Overflow etc) **you must reference the original source**. This can be done in your documentation as comments or part of your write ups. Students found to be utilising code without referencing could face an academic offence. **If in doubt speak to your Module Leader.**

Versioning

A critical part of a development (software or academic) is versioning. Keeping a number of iterations over the course of development ensures you always have backups to fall back on. It also provides clear demonstration of the development process you implemented.

Using online/cloud-based storage solutions and repositories provide additional peace of mind, alongside being industry practice. The university provide OneDrive to all students which offers inbuilt version history for Microsoft products. GitHub is the university recommended repository for versioning code, which includes great integration with a number of IDEs.

Submitting Code

It is vital that you confirm that all code that you submit is in the **correct format** and **compiles correctly** or **runs without error**. If you clean up your code before submission, please ensure that all dependencies (libraries, functions and variables) are included so that the marker can compile your code.

We can only mark what has been submitted. If the code does not run correctly, it is not our responsibility to spend time error handling to award you marks.

It is also important to **show your working**. Tidying up your code is a critical part of coding practices, but if you remove the workings that provides you with the required output, we cannot see how you got there.

In a worst-case scenario, if you remove a key part of your working, and on compiling your code it gives an error or different result, we have no way of confirming what went wrong, or indeed if you fabricated those outputs.

Please note, just because a piece of code has given the wrong output, it does not mean it should be deleted. Seeing these attempts with comments documenting your attempt allows us to understand where you may have made an error and provide feedback that addresses this. In some cases, you could also be awarded marks for the attempt.

Phase 1: Supervisor Selection

Task:
During the first two weeks of the module, you have the opportunity to formulate your own ideas for your project supported by the opportunity to talk to different potential supervisors. There will be an initial seminar set up in the first week of the module where you can have those discussions. You may also make arrangements to meet and discuss your ideas during these initial weeks with potential supervisors.

Once you have a clear idea of who you would like to be your project supervisor, you **MUST** gain their agreement **BEFORE** signing up to their group on the DLE using the link "Supervisor Selection" illustrated in the figure below. This link will only be accessible after the set-up meeting.

Supervisor Groups

Signing up for a Supervisor

Each member of staff has an allocation for students. You are expected to attend the networking event in the first week of Semester 1 where you meet members of staff. During this event you can discuss ideas, or if you have a clear plan, the project you wish to work on. At this stage, you can approach any member of staff to request their supervision. Once you have agreement by the member of staff, you choose them here.

Please be aware that even if you and the supervisor agree, it may not be possible for that supervisor to take you on if they have already reached their allocation.

Once you have an agreed supervisor, it is your responsibility to sign up to that supervisors group given below.

Final allocations for supervisors will be confirmed and set at the end of the second week of the first semester.

Supervisor Selection

Please use this link to choose your supervisor.

You cannot choose a supervisor who is already full and you can ONLY choose a supervisor that you have had a discussion with.

DO NOT sign up for a supervisor without meeting that supervisor first. If you fail to do this you will be removed from the supervisor list.

You may only sign up for one supervisor.

You must have completed your selection by the date specified. You will NOT be able to access this facility after the deadline date and time!

Students who have not signed up to a supervisor by the cut-off date will be randomly allocated to a supervisor in the week after the selection process closes.

Once you have your supervisor agreed please update section 01. “Supervisor Selection” within your ePortfolio.

ePortfolio Evidence:

a. Completed supervisor selection on DLE
b. Complete Section “01. Supervisor Selection” on ePortfolio

Phase 2: Project Initiation

Task:
This deliverable is the output from the culmination of your sprint zero. Sprint zero should be spent getting yourself ready for delivering the project. You should identify the point and purpose of your project. This will require you to think of a title and work up a project Vision. Please do not consider that your project title and project vision are immutable – they can change as you develop your ideas. However, you need to know at the start roughly where you want to develop your ideas. By ensuring you start with a coherent project title and project vision, you can ensure you start in an organised fashion.

Sprint zero should also be about deciding which languages and technologies to use, setting up your development environment, sorting out your version-controlled repository, identifying your test environment, identifying the things that could go wrong and creating your initial product backlog. The product backlog will be an evolving, living item that changes and evolves as the project progresses. However, you need to ensure that there is enough in the product backlog to begin with. You should also include a high-level plan to show roughly when you intend to complete certain things – a recommended format would be a Gantt chart. Please refer to the documentation on the DLE around project management to help you with this.

You should use appropriate project management tools such as a planner and a diary. Being able to use a diary and control your time is an essential part of being a professional.

Students need to use the provided GitHub repository. Ensure your supervisor has access to your repository and edit the readme.md file so that your project title, vision and allocated supervisor are clearly noted. Make sure the name of the repository reflects your name.

This is the stage where you must also give some consideration as to the potential for things to go wrong. Please read around the topic matter and identify what pertinent risks there might be to your project. Once you have identified what could go wrong, you need to consider the likelihood of that happening and what you will do about it. Any risks that have a high likelihood and a high impact MUST have actions identified to prevent them should the events happen.

ePortfolio Evidence:

a. Ensured supervisor has access to your GitHub repository
b. Complete Section “02. Project Initiation” on ePortfolio containing:
    - ⇒ Project Title
    - ⇒ Keywords
    - ⇒ Project Vision
    - ⇒ Risk Assessment
    - ⇒ Gantt Chart

Phase 3: Poster and Description (Showcase Materials)

Task:
The project showcase is an important event in terms of ensuring student work gets good visibility with potential employers. Computing academics have many contacts in industry and those contacts are keen to see the work carried out by final year students.

Attending the showcase is **mandatory**. Contributions to it are marked in the practice section and are indicated in the marking schema. **Failure** to attend could result in a mark reduction. The date of the showcase itself is in your timetable for the module, As well as the tale above.

In preparation for the showcase, you must produce a poster and a thumbnail image.

The poster should be based on your project vision and provide the reader with a glimpse into how you are applying the technology to solve the problem you have identified. The poster should include details around the project statement, the chosen solution, the chosen methodology and any results and findings. It is good practice to include screenshots of the app showing of key functionality and design decisions.

The purpose of the poster is to provide enough information so that somebody can understand what your project is about and an indication as to how you are putting your software together. It does NOT require you to have completed your software.

There are **two** submissions for the Poster (see Table 1 for deadlines):

a. A draft version for formative feedback (optional)
b. A final print-ready version for the Showcase (mandatory)

You **MUST** submit a poster for printing by the print deadline listed above. However, you have a chance to submit a draft version of your poster to your supervisor for formative feedback. This will allow you to take the feedback onboard and make any changes you wish to your poster before the print deadline.

The print-ready version of the poster is used for the Showcase, and acts as the billboard advertising you and your project. First impressions count! We will download the version of the poster present within the portfolio on the deadline for printing. So, if you make changes to your draft just reupload the relevant files within Section “03. Poster & Description” in the ePortfolio.

If you do not provide a poster by the print deadline, or make changes to it before the showcase, **you will be responsible** for printing your own poster. The library has a large format printer you can use (there is a charge to use this).

You can use any software you wish to make the poster and thumbnail, including PowerPoint. Ensure your poster is **A1** in size, **landscape orientation**. This must be saved as .jpg with following naming convention:

- Poster = "<StudentID>.jpg" where <StudentID> is your student ID.

- Thumbnail = "<StudentID>-thumb.jpg" where <StudentID> is your student ID.

Your thumbnail should be a smaller resolution file that gives the overall impression of the main poster file. It is used to help the webpages load quicker and therefore would usually be much smaller than the poster itself (perhaps 100k). You could create one using ‘Snipping Tool’ in Windows or use a photo editing app like Photos (Windows 10/11) to resize. Choosing preset options for “Best for profile pictures and thumbnails” often yields good results.

ePortfolio Evidence:

a. Complete Section “03. Project & Description” on ePortfolio containing:
   - ⇒ Finalised Project Title
   - ⇒ Finalised Project Description
   - ⇒ Updated Keywords
   - ⇒ Poster file in jpg format, **landscape** orientation. File to be named with your student ID eg: 123456.jpg.
   - ⇒ Thumbnail file of poster in .jpg format. **Landscape** orientation. File to be named with your student ID e.g. 123456_thumb.jpg.

Phase 4: Project Portfolio

Task:
Your final project ePortfolio will consist of a number of items detailed below.

1. A version-controlled repository with organised code and an informative readme.md. Your report submission must contain a link to your repository. Obviously, your code should work for high marks.
2. A poster illustrating your project. You may change your poster from the submission in Phase 3 following formative feedback from your supervisor.
3. A thumbnail file of your poster. See the point above.
4. A working instance of your software to be shown in your video and during your demo. This will form part of your practice submission for this module.
5. A 5-minute video (+-10%) showing the top-level highlights of your software. This also forms part of your practice submission for this module.
6. A 10,000-word-report documenting your project and the processes that supported the development of your project. This is a substantial piece of writing that should be drafted, redrafted and worked on over a period of time, not left until the last minute. This should include details of all tools and technologies used, including GenAI tools.
7. A series of **THREE reflections** from various project and CPD development activities from throughout the year. These **should include** what you learned from the event and how they have made you think/work differently You are encouraged to reflect on how these could develop your work.

All elements **should be** uploaded to the appropriate pages on the ePortfolio.

ePortfolio Evidence:

a. Link to version-controlled repository
b. Final poster
c. Final poster thumbnail
d. Working Instance of your software
e. 5-minute video demo
f. 10,000 word report
g. Summary of CPD activities and reflections

Phase 5: Viva

Task:
The final part of the module is a face-to-face project viva that will take a maximum of 30 minutes. During this session you should provide a 10-minute presentation to two examiners. The presentation should not cover in depth what has already been shown in the video but cover any part of the application in more depth that is required. The remaining time will be for questions and feedback.

Failure to attend your project viva will result in the failure of the whole module.

MARKING CRITERIA: Coursework – 80% (CW1)

	Level descriptors. *Note that these definitions are indicative of expected standards at each level, and may not be precise descriptors of the project submitted.*						
Category and marks weighting:	<30%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%
Project definition & planning (10%) "Scene setting" & defining the project aims & objectives, considers the problem domain and/or research question/task/problem (aims & objectives). Producing, adhering to and iteratively updating a structured project plan, considering time, resources, cost & ethics. Project vision is clear. Sprint plans map to backlog and aims. Releases planned every two weeks with appropriate plans and reviews.	Task totally unclear, undefined and/or irrelevant.	Inadequate task definition; very poorly defined.	Task definition under-developed; vague and/or illogical.	Task clarity and/or validity could improve.	Clear and sensibly defined task.	Task very well defined, explained and justified.	Perfect task definition; concise, compelling, SMART.
	Little/no evidence of having prepared or followed a structured project plan.	Inadequate project planning; tasks vague and/or illogically planned.	Some project planning and logic but needs much more thought, detail and/or clarity.	Project mostly well planned & managed. Some questionable logic and/or may lack detail.	Project generally well planned and managed.	Clear and logical project planning; dynamic response to setbacks/new discoveries.	Professional project management throughout all stages of the project.
Context review & subject knowledge (15%) Presenting a review of published literature that is relevant to this study with appropriate critical comment. OR presents a review of context of problem with appropriate critical comment. Using correct and appropriate citations throughout the report. Showing a clear understanding of relevant subject matter throughout the project. Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional issues clearly and appropriately discussed along with appropriate critical comment and authoritative citations.	Little/no review of appropriate literature.	Minimal literature review. No critical comment; serious gaps/omissions.	Some literature review; little attempt at critical comment. Large gaps and omissions.	A range of relevant literature reviewed; some omissions. Some valid critical comment.	Appropriate breadth & depth to literature review; minor gaps. Good critical comment.	Comprehensive and very well written literature review with valid critical review throughout.	Comprehensive literature review: peer reviewed journal standard.
	Missing/irrelevant list of references. Absence of valid citations throughout report.	Superficial reference list and/or predominately incorrect/inadequate citations.	Reference list present. Major presentation issues and/or poor citation style.	Reference list and/or citations could be more clearly/correctly presented.	Most citations and reference list entries correctly presented; some minor issues.	Highly competent use of citations and reference list.	Extensive list of references and citation style: peer reviewed journal standard.

	Little/No evidence of understanding of relevant subject matter throughout the project.	Inadequate understanding of relevant subject matter; confused &/or lacking depth.	Some understanding of subject matter with errors &/or poor conceptual framework.	Reasonable understanding of subject matter; minor errors. May require more depth.	Good understanding of subject matter with a clear conceptual framework.	Excellent understanding of subject matter beyond the level of taught modules.	Expert understanding of subject matter with rigorous attention to relevant detail.
	Little or no evidence of understanding of appropriate LSEP issues.	Inadequate understanding of relevant LSEP issues. Vague mentions made with little demonstrable understanding	Some understanding of LSEP issues with errors &/or poor conceptual framework.	Reasonable understanding of LSEP issues; minor errors. May require more depth.	Good understanding of LSEP issues with a clear conceptual framework.	Excellent understanding of LSEP issues beyond the level of taught modules.	Expert understanding of LSEP issues with rigorous attention to relevant detail.
Project methodology and implementation (50%) Defining an appropriate methodology and discussion of alternatives. Implementing the methodology to a depth appropriate for a 40 credit module. Demonstrating appropriate skills in the implementation of that methodology; skills depend on type of project (experimental, creative, mathematical, computational, etc.) Implementation of agile artifacts match proposed plans earlier or deviation from plan discussed appropriately. Implementation of code at appropriate level with demonstration of good software engineering principles. eg. DRY, YAGNI, SOLID.	Absence of anything that could reasonably be called a methodology.	Little/no justification for methodology &/or inappropriate methodology.	Some lack of logic/depth in justifying methodology. Major flaws in method selected.	Reasonable justification & selection of methodology with some flaws/errors/omissions.	Sensible, justified methodology selection with minor limitations.	Appropriate, well justified methodology selected. Good awareness of limitations.	Expertly justified; optimum methodology selected with due regard for limitations.
	Little or no relevant work done to achieve project aims & objectives.	Minimal relevant work done to achieve project aims & objectives.	Some relevant work but far short of that expected in the time allocated for 40 credits.	Project engagement &/or depth of coverage of task could improve.	Good project engagement and coverage of the task.	Good depth of coverage of the task, showing a high level of project engagement.	Comprehensive coverage of a highly demanding task. Very high level of engagement.
	Little or no evidence of relevant skills in project implementation.	Poor skills in implementing the methodology - incorrect &/or very confused.	Some skill in implementing the methodology, but with errors &/or confusion.	Skill in most areas of methodology implementation - some issues/errors.	Competent implementation of methodology with minor issues/errors.	Highly skilled implementation of methodology (far beyond the level of	Expert level of skill in all relevant areas clearly evident throughout.

						taught modules).	
	Little or no evidence of implementation of agile project management	Minimal relevant work done to implement agile.	Some relevant work but far short of that expected for an agile project	Agile engagement &/or depth of coverage of task could improve.	Good agile application and coverage of the task.	Good depth of coverage of agile, high level of engagement with theory leading to good implementation. Agile worthy of commercial environment	Comprehensive coverage of a highly demanding agile implementation. Very high level of engagement.

	Little or no evidence of coding skills in project implementation.	Poor skills in implementing code - incorrect &/or very confused.	Some skill in implementing the software, but with errors &/or confusion. Application provides more functionality than log in and registration.	Skill in most areas of software implementation - some issues/errors. Implementation of moderate complexity with suitable functionality demonstrated.	Competent implementation of software with minor issues/errors. Application is of suitable complexity, has appropriate storage for any data, architecture is not monolithic but demonstrates interactions between levels and/or layers of software.	Highly skilled implementation of software (far beyond the level of taught modules). Application and architecture have good complexity, and good quality software engineering. Data storage if required is good, application goes way beyond a form of data storage with front end.	Expert level of skill in all relevant areas clearly evident throughout. Software is of commercial quality and could be implemented in real world situation with very little modification. OR research of quality that could easily lead to publication.
Critical evaluation & conclusions (15%) Appropriate mathematical/statistical methods to process & present data if appropriate. Software testing, verification and validation appropriate. Discussion/critical evaluation of results. Drawing the results together to form clear conclusions linked	A complete absence of appropriate data analysis.	Fundamentally flawed or inappropriate data analysis/processing.	Some relevant data analysis/processing with major issues/errors.	Appropriate data analysis/processing with some issues/errors.	Competent data analysis/processing with minor issues/errors.	Highly competent data processing/analysis & treatment of uncertainty.	Expert mathematical data processing; skillful error/sensitivity analysis.

to the project aims and objectives (quantitative if appropriate). Recommendations for further work. Taking feedback and findings from events and applying this to the project.	Project is devoid of appropriate testing plan	Poor skills in applying testing, incorrect &/or very confused	Some relevant testing applied. V&V superficial, sparse &/or often flawed	Appropriate testing in place but with some omissions, issues &/or errors	Competent testing plan in place. Appropriate Validation and Verification approach in place.	Highly competent testing regime in place both in plan and implementation. Shows a deep understanding of testing above and beyond taught modules.	Expert testing plans and implementations in place, could be appropriate for commercial application with very little modification.
	Project is devoid of critical analysis and evaluation.	Poor critical awareness showing little understanding of project results.	Critical evaluation is superficial, sparse and/or often flawed.	Appropriate critical evaluation in some areas with some omissions, issues and/or errors.	Competent critical evaluation in most areas of the project.	Highly competent critical awareness showing a good understanding of results.	Expert critical analysis throughout, showing deep understanding of results.
	Absent/irrelevant conclusions.	Inadequate/unjustified conclusions.	Conclusions vague and/or largely unjustified.	Relevant conclusions. Accuracy, evidence and/or clarity could improve.	Logical conclusions predominantly evidence-based and clearly presented.	Appropriate, well presented and well justified conclusions.	Clear, concise and fully quantitively justified conclusions.
Structure and presentation (10%) Structuring the report such that it is easy to follow, with information delivered in the right order, to an appropriate level of detail.	Little or no coherent report structure.	Structure lacks logic - rather "thrown together".	Some structure but disjointed/confusing.	Structure reasonable but could be easier to follow.	Sensible structure with minor issues/errors.	Excellent; clear and logical structure.	Faultless structure - perfectly presented.

Using appropriate grammar and language. Clearly presenting any mathematical work. Using appropriate, clear figures, images and graphs with correct labels, units, titles, etc.	Writing &/or mathematical notation incomprehensible.	Inappropriate written work and/or mathematical notation.	Poor literacy and/or mathematical notation.	Mainly appropriate style of writing and mathematical presentation - could improve.	Clear style of writing and mathematical presentation.	Lucid style of writing. Clear, unambiguous mathematical presentation.	Literacy/mathematical presentation: peer reviewed journal standard.
	Images/graphs /figs sparse, illegible and/or irrelevant.	Images/graphs /figs do not convey required information.	Most images/graphs /figs convey required information but may lack clarity and/or contain errors.	Mainly appropriate images/ graphs/figs - aesthetics and/or labelling could improve.	Most images/graphs /figs of high standard; occasional minor errors/issues.	Images/graphs /figs of high standard, clearly conveying all required information.	Creative images/graphs /figs; peer reviewed journal standard.

MARKING CRITERIA: Practice – 20% (PW1)

	Level descriptors. *Note that these definitions are indicative of expected standards at each level, and may not be precise descriptors of the project submitted.*						
Category and marks weighting:	<30%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%
Communication of information (40%) The poster should be pitched at an audience that is scientifically literate, but non-expert in this particular subject specialism. The video is for a more specialist technical audience. They should communicate: • The rationale for the project and the project aims (with any essential background information). • What has been done over the course of the project. • A summary of project results/discussion. • The main project conclusions. Viva reflects upon the whole of the project and presents a summary of project results. Video presents highlights for the project and a summary of the project output/results. Poster presents main rationale for the project Showcase poster discussion covering main project outputs/results	Task totally unclear, undefined and/or irrelevant.	Inadequate task definition; very poorly defined and/or explained.	Task definition under-developed; vague, illogical and/or poorly explained.	Task clarity and/or explanation could improve.	Clear and sensibly defined task - well explained.	Task very well defined and explained.	Perfect task definition; concise, compelling and very clearly explained.
	Little/no explanation of what was done over the course of the project.	Explanation provides little insight into what was done over the course of the project.	Some explanation of what was done - rather vague/confusing.	A useful explanation of what was done - clarity could improve.	A clear explanation of what was done over the course of the project.	A clear, concise and informative explanation of what was done.	Explanation clearly conveys technically demanding project work to non-expert audience.
	Little/no presentation of project results.	Minimal insight into key project results.	Some presentation of project results - rather vague/confusing.	Useful presentation of project results - clarity could improve.	Clear presentation of key project results.	Key project results are efficiently, creatively and clearly presented.	Innovative presentation of results - appropriate to non-expert audience.
	Absent/irrelevant conclusions.	Inadequate/unjustified conclusions.	Conclusions vague and/or largely unjustified.	Relevant conclusions. Accuracy, evidence and/or clarity could improve.	Logical conclusions predominantly evidence-based and clearly presented.	Appropriate, well presented and well justified conclusions.	Clear, concise and fully quantitively justified conclusions.

	Text and/or mathematical notation incomprehensible.	Inappropriate text and/or mathematical notation.	Poor literacy and/or mathematical notation.	Mainly appropriate text and mathematical presentation - could improve.	Clear, concise text and mathematical presentation.	Efficient, appropriate use of text. Clear, unambiguous mathematical presentation.	Text/mathematical presentation of professional poster standard.
	Images/graphs /figs sparse, illegible and/or irrelevant.	Images/graphs /figs do not convey required information.	Most images/graphs /figs convey required information but may lack clarity and/or contain errors.	Mainly appropriate images/ graphs/figs - aesthetics and/or labelling could improve.	Most images/graphs /figs of high standard; occasional minor errors/issues.	Images/graphs /figs of high standard, clearly conveying all required information.	Creative images/graphs /figs; professional poster standard.
Poster structure & aesthetics (20%) The poster should deliver information in a clear, logical order. It should be aesthetically pleasing and visually exciting. It should not appear too cluttered, but also not too sparse, with a good balance of text and images (such as pictures, graphs, formulae, etc).	No thought given to poster structure or aesthetics.	Very poorly structured poster and/or very little aesthetic appeal.	Poster is not very attractively presented - may be rather messy and/or poorly structured.	Poster is reasonably visually appealing. Might lack some structure and/or tidiness.	Good poster structure and aesthetics.	Poster is effective, attractive and exciting. Very well thought out structure.	A true "work of art" - striking and exciting. Very clearly and creatively structured.
	Inappropriate amount of content; either far too cluttered or far too sparse.	Little thought to achieving the right balance or quantity of text and images.	Poor balance between text and images and/or quite cluttered or sparse.	Balance of text and images could be better, and/or a bit too cluttered or sparse.	Reasonable balance between text and images - about the right amount of content.	A good balance of text and images - not too cluttered or sparse.	Exactly the right amount of content with excellent balance between text and images.

Viva (25%) Verbal presentation of the project (what you did, why, and what you discovered). Your response to the moderator's questions should demonstrate a deep understanding of the subject matter and the implications of your results.	Little/no ability to verbally communicate technical information.	Inadequate verbal communicatio n of technical information.	Verbal communicatio n of technical information is very difficult to follow.	Mostly effective verbal communicatio n of relevant concepts/outc omes.	Good verbal communicatio n of relevant concepts/outc omes.	Clear and eloquent verbal presentation of relevant concepts/outc omes.	Expert verbal communicatio n; concepts/outc omes pitched at the right audience level.
	Little/No coherent response to moderator's questions.	Vague, very confused and/or factually incorrect response to moderator's questions.	Response to moderator's questions shows limited grasp of necessary concepts.	Some sensible responses to moderator's questions - a bit naive and/or lacking depth.	Mostly clear, sensible responses to moderator's questions.	Clear, well-informed response to all moderator's questions.	Comprehensiv e, expert response to moderator's questions.
Professionalism (15%) Engaging with the project and demonstrating the appropriate professionalism skills of a developer/researcher. Including Continued Professional Development (CPD). Demonstrating these skills include: • Engagement with supervision process • Attending the Showcase and other project events • Being punctual to project events	Rare or no engagement with supervision process.	Limited engagement with the supervision process.	Minimal but consistent engagement with supervision with minimal response to feedback.	Regular engagement with supervision process.	Regular and proactive engagement with supervision.	Strong and proactive engagement with supervision, seeking and applying feedback.	Excellent, proactive and consistent engagement with supervision, actively seeking and applying feedback.
	Failure to attend the Showcase and other project events.	Failure to attend the showcase, turning up late to other project events.	Attend the majority of events with some participation.	Attend most project events and is generally punctual.	Attends project events with active participation.	Well-prepared for events and makes clear, positive contributions.	Attends all events, takes leadership and plays a highly active role.

Acceptable levels of AI use:
The table below provides the acceptable use categories for GenAI. Each assessment element may allow different uses. Please check the brief for each element carefully to see what uses are allowed.

Solo Work	**S1 - Generative AI tools have not been used for this assessment.**
Assisted Work	**A1 – Idea Generation and Problem Exploration** Used to generate project ideas, explore different approaches to solving a problem, or suggest features for software or systems. Students must critically assess AI-generated suggestions and ensure their own intellectual contributions are central.
	A2 - Planning & Structuring Projects AI may help outline the structure of reports, documentation and projects. The final structure and implementation must be the student's own work.
	A3 – Code Architecture AI tools maybe used to help outline code architecture (e.g. suggesting class hierarchies or module breakdowns). The final code structure must be the student's own work.
	A4 – Research Assistance Used to locate and summarise relevant articles, academic papers, technical documentation, or online resources (e.g. Stack Overflow, GitHub discussions. The interpretation and integration of research into the assignment remain the student's responsibility.
	A5 - Language Refinement Used to check grammar, refine language, improve sentence structure in documentation not code. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the documentation accurately reflects the code and is technically correct.
	A6 – Code Review AI tools can be used to check comments within the code and to suggest improvements to code readability, structure or syntax. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the code accurately reflects their knowledge and is technically correct.
	A7 - Code Generation for Learning Purposes Used to generate example code snippets to understand syntax, explore alternative implementations, or learn new programming paradigms. Students must not submit AI-generated code as their own and must be able to explain how it works.
	A8 - Technical Guidance & Debugging Support AI tools can be used to explain algorithms, programming concepts, or debugging strategies. Students may also help interpret error messages or suggest possible fixes. However, students must write, test, and debug their own code independently and understand all solutions submitted.
	A9 - Testing and Validation Support AI may assist in generating test cases, validating outputs, or suggesting edge cases for software testing. Students are responsible for designing comprehensive test plans and interpreting test results.
	A10 - Data Analysis and Visualization Guidance AI tools can help suggest ways to analyse datasets or visualize results (e.g. recommending chart types or statistical methods). Students must perform the analysis themselves and understand the implications of the results.
	A11 - Other uses not listed above Please specify:
Partnered Work	**P1 - Generative AI tool usage has been used integrally for this assessment** Students can adopt approaches that are compliant with instructions in the assessment brief. Please Specify:

General Guidance

Extenuating Circumstances

There may be a time during this module where you experience a serious situation which has a significant impact on your ability to complete the assessments. The definition of these can be found in the University Policy on Extenuating Circumstances here:
https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/extenuating-circumstances

Plagiarism

All of your work must be of your own words. You must use references for your sources, however you acquire them. Where you wish to use quotations, these must be a very minor part of your overall work.

To copy another person's work is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously. All your work must be your own and other sources must be identified as being theirs, not yours. The copying of another persons' work could result in a penalty being invoked.

Further information on plagiarism policy can be found here:

Plagiarism: https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/regulations/plagiarism

Examination Offences: https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/examination-offences

Turnitin (http://www.turnitinuk.com/) is an Internet-based 'originality checking tool' which allows documents to be compared with content on the Internet, in journals and in an archive of previously submitted works. It can help to detect unintentional or deliberate plagiarism.

It is a formative tool that makes it easy for students to review their citations and referencing as an aid to learning good academic practice. Turnitin produces an 'originality report' to help guide you. To learn more about Turnitin go to:
https://help.turnitin.com/new-links.htm?Highlight=guide

The university also had Draft Coach available on the online version of Microsoft Word. Draft Coach is a Turnitin plugin and provides instant feedback on how to address citation issues, grammar mistakes and matches with Turnitin's database.

Referencing

The University of Plymouth Library has produced an online support referencing guide which is available here: http://plymouth.libguides.com/referencing

Another recommended referencing resource is Cite Them Right Online; this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.